

4X4 EXPEDITION RIG

The 4x4 Expedition Rig Overland Gear Checklist

SUVs are the gold standard for overlanding — enclosed cargo, high ground clearance, and proven 4WD systems. This checklist covers the essential gear for a capable, expedition-ready SUV build. Priority: 1 = do first, 2 = next season, 3 = nice-to-have.

RECOVERY & SAFETY

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| ■ | WARN ZEON 10-S Winch
Premium choice for 4Runners, Land Cruisers, Broncos. Permanent-magnet motor, IP68.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-winches.html | Priority 1 |
| ■ | MaxTrax MKII Recovery Boards (pair)
Essential recovery tool. Works in sand, mud, and snow.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-recovery-gear.html | Priority 1 |
| ■ | Kinetic Recovery Rope + Shackles
Rated shackles only — soft shackles preferred for safety.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-recovery-gear.html | Priority 1 |
| ■ | ARB Skid Plate System
Protect engine, transfer case, and fuel tank on technical terrain.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-skid-plates-for-off-road-trucks.html | Priority 1 |
| ■ | Overlanding First Aid Kit
Remote-rated kit with tourniquet, wound packing, and SAM splint.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-first-aid-kit-essentials.html | Priority 1 |
| ■ | Portable Air Compressor (ARB CKMTA12)
Airing down and back up is essential for trail performance. | Priority 1 |
| ■ | Fire Extinguisher (2.5 lb ABC)
Mount within reach of driver. | Priority 1 |

SLEEPING & SHELTER

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| ■ iKamper Skycamp 3.0 RTT | Priority 1 |
| Best rooftop tent for SUVs. 2-person, hard shell, 60-second setup.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/rooftop-tent-buying-guide.html | |
| ■ Roof Rack (Prinsu, Yakima, Rhino-Rack) | Priority 1 |
| Required for RTT mount. Choose one rated for your tent's weight. | |
| ■ Ground Tent (backup) | Priority 3 |
| For guests or when RTT isn't practical. | |
| ■ Sleeping Bags (rated to 20°F) | Priority 1 |
| Even summer nights at elevation can drop below freezing. | |

POWER & REFRIGERATION

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| ■ Dometic CFX3 45 Fridge / Freezer | Priority 1 |
| Compact, efficient, and bombproof. Fits behind 2nd row in most SUVs.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-fridges.html | |
| ■ Dual Battery System (Lithium preferred) | Priority 1 |
| 100Ah lithium + DC-DC charger. Powers fridge, lights, and devices.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-solar-and-power.html | |
| ■ Renogy 200W Solar Panel (roof mount) | Priority 2 |
| Keeps battery topped off at camp without running the engine.
trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-solar-and-power.html | |
| ■ Victron SmartSolar MPPT Controller | Priority 2 |
| Best-in-class solar controller. Bluetooth monitoring. | |

LIGHTING

■	ARB Intensity Solis Lights (pair) Best pod lights for SUVs. IP69K rated, 5-year warranty. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-off-road-light-bars.html	Priority 2
■	KC HiLiTES Gravity LED Pro6 (pair) Excellent A-pillar or bumper-mount option for 4Runners and Broncos. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-off-road-light-bars.html	Priority 2
■	Rear Work Lights Invaluable for camp setup after dark.	Priority 3

NAVIGATION & COMMUNICATION

■	Garmin inReach Mini 2 Satellite communicator. Non-negotiable for remote travel. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-vehicle-communication-gear-for-overlanding.html	Priority 1
■	Onx Offroad App Best digital trail map. Download maps offline before you go.	Priority 1
■	GMRS Radio (Midland MXT275) Convoy communication and camp coordination. trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-vehicle-communication-gear-for-overlanding.html	Priority 2
■	Garmin Overlander GPS Dedicated GPS with topo maps and track logging.	Priority 2

WATER & CAMP

■	Rotopax 2-Gal Water Packs (×2)	Priority 1
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Mounts to roof rack or rear door. Compact and trail-rated.

trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-water-storage-and-filtration.html

■	Sawyer Squeeze Water Filter	Priority 1
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Lightweight backup water treatment. Works with any water source.

trailbuiltoverland.com/articles/best-overlanding-water-storage-and-filtration.html

■	Camp Kitchen (2-burner propane stove)	Priority 1
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Coleman Triton or Camp Chef Everest. Reliable and easy to find fuel for.

■	Fuel Caddy (Rotopax 2-gal, ×2)	Priority 2
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Adds 50–80 miles of range. Mount to roof rack or rear door.